

Password & Authentication Standard

Document ID	IT-STD-003
Version	2.0
Status	Approved
Effective date	2026-02-01
Owner	IT Security
Supersedes	IT-STD-003 v1.0

Passwords

Corporate passwords must be at least **16 characters** long. Passphrases are encouraged. Passwords are **no longer rotated on a schedule**; they must be changed immediately if compromise is suspected. (Version 1.0 required 14 characters and rotation every 180 days.)

Multi-factor authentication

MFA is mandatory for all corporate accounts. Hardware security keys are mandatory for administrators and for anyone with production access. SMS codes are not an accepted second factor.

Lockout

After 5 failed sign-in attempts the account locks for 30 minutes. Self-service reset is available at <https://reset.northwind.example>.